



Our challenges don't define us. Our actions do.

PLAN OF ATTACK • WORKSHEET #3

PD Symptoms

PD Symptoms: Motor and Non-Motor

This list is not meant to scare you for what's to come because in all honesty you may never experience some of these symptoms because everyone with Parkinson's is different. This list is ONLY to educate you so you are aware of what symptoms are associated to the disease vs ones that aren't. It will also be a great tool for you to see what symptoms are indeed due to Parkinson's and how you can be proactive about it.

Main Symptoms

Tremor	Shaking of one body part or multiple body parts, typically more pronounced on one side of the body
Muscle Rigidity	Stiffness in some areas or multiple areas of the body. Most prominent in the thoracic/core region of the body
Slowness (Bradykinesia)	Slow movements especially during 'off' phase. BIG movements need to be emphasized all throughout class as much as possible so students continue to move BIG in their home outside of class.
Postural Instability	Poor posture which could lead to poor balance

Secondary Symptoms

Stooped Posture	Consists of leaning forward therefore your centre of gravity will shift and this can possibly increase your chance of falling. Back pain and overall body stiffness is often common but definitely treatable.
Shuffling Gait	Small, hesitant steps which can lead to shuffling gate. Walking as BIG (amplitude is key here) as possible can help retrain your brain to walk with a more normal gate pattern.



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Secondary Motor Symptoms

Decreased Arm Swing	One arm may swing slightly or not at all compared to your other arm
Lack of facial expression	Clients often have a masked expression because the stiffness can often be in their face as well as the rest of their body. VOICE exercises for the win here 😊 will help improve this.
Microphagia	Very small handwriting, often one of the first signs of the disease
Difficulty getting out of bed and turning over	Stiffness is often worse in the morning so warm up and cool down stretches are important.

Secondary Non-Motor Symptoms

Voice is Quiet & Difficulty Speaking	70-90% of persons with PD will develop speech difficulties over the course of the disease, sometimes speech can be the first symptom.
Painful Muscle cramps	Often in the feet but can present elsewhere in the body
Poor sleeping patterns, hallucinations, vivid dreams	All of these symptoms are often seen with a PD diagnosis but can exacerbate with medication change or being on a medication for a prolonged period. SLEEP schedule a must here for optimal sleep.
Depression & Anxiety	Some people with Parkinson's isolate themselves from friends and family and social activities. They tend to have increased anxiety which can exacerbate their symptoms. They can become fearful and overwhelmed quite easily. Working with your health care professional to make sure your anxiety and depression are being addressed is key here and there are many effective treatments and medications that can work wonders. If you stay in a rut of depression or anxiety you will be working against your body, possibly causing a negative effect to the rest of your health.



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Cognitive Issues & Dementia-	Can be seen in PD population and exists on a continuum of severity; prevalence can increase with the duration of the movement disorder. EXERCISE can help to slow down progression and improve overall cognitive health especially the sooner the better.
Skin Problems	Oily or Scaly skin which can lead to dry skin. I recommend non-skid socks or wearing indoor shoes if needed when exercising. **Coconut oil is a great for dry skin and you can apply it generously to your feet and wear socks overnight to hold in moisture.
Constipation	Is very common among PD students. It's important to speak with your health care professionals to get your gut on track as your digestive health has proven to be a very important part of the PD puzzle.
Low Blood Pressure	Low blood pressure is quite common among people with PD. It can either be a symptom related to PD or a side effect from the medication. There are many modifications to exercises that consists of going down and back up so make sure to be aware of them in your exercise class and don't be afraid to ask for assistance if needed. It is very important to get comfortable with the ground so learning how to get down to the ground and back up should be a part of your exercise program.
Loss of Smell	A lost, or impaired, sense of smell is considered among the very earliest warning signs of Parkinson's Disease. It can sometimes occur as much as several years prior to other symptoms developing and is medically referred to as anosmia.